Secretary of the Asiatic Society of Bengal, was assigned the task and with the help of Kavali Venkata Laksmiah produced a catalogue that when published in 1828 filled two volumes. The bulk of the papers were sent to the Library of the Madras College, where they lay largely untouched for some decades, which meant that Mackenzie's hoard of Jain manuscripts remained unexamined.[5]

In the meantime it was India's other 'lost' religion that became the main focus of antiquarian interest, leading to the sidelining of Jain studies for over half a century, so that it came to be regarded, in the words of a later student of Jain studies, 'as grey and unappealing, as austere as its followers ... its tenets less profound than Buddhism, its mythology less spectacular than that of Hinduism'.[6] This neglect lasted into the 1870s, the turning point being the visit in 1874 of the German Indologists Hermann Jacobi and Georg Bühler to the remote outpost of Jaisalmer in the Rajasthan desert, where they found a cache of neglected Jain manuscripts in the library of the local Rajput rulers. These documents included the teachings of the sect's founder, Mahavira, as well as accounts of the lives of Mahavira and his predecessors recorded in the *Kalpa Sutra*.[7] With the support of their German academic colleagues in Oxford and Berlin, Jacobi and Bühler brought the Jain religion to the attention of the wider world, showing its philosophy and culture to be as rich as that of its rival.[8]

The Jain faith had emerged as a distinctive religion with defined beliefs and practices in the late sixth or early fifth century BCE in the most technologically advanced of the Arya *mahajanapada*s in the Gangetic plains, Magadha. Trading between these *janapada*s had led to the growth of an increasingly wealthy mercantile class, creating an urban elite of Kshatriya landlords and Vaishya traders who now had the wealth, power and opportunity to challenge Brahminical orthodoxy, giving rise to a variety of heterodox